INDEPENDENT REGULATORY COMPLIANCE ASSESSMENT

# HOSPITAL PRICE TRANSPARENCY AUDIT

Independent Diagnostic Gap Analysis & Regulatory Exposure Assessment (45 CFR Part 180)

DATE: October 24, 2026

STANDARD: Hospital Price Transparency (45 CFR 180)

AUDITED HEALTHCARE FACILITY

## Clarion Psychiatric Center

Audited Source: 232842434-clarion-standard_charges.csv [->]

**NON-COMPLIANT: DEFECTS DETECTED**

**Mandatory Statutory Remediation Required (45 CFR Section 180)**

| SCANNED ROWS | FLAGGED VIOLATIONS | SAFETY SCORE |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | 19 | 40.8% (Grade F) |
| Machine-Readable CDM Records | Non-Compliant Data Coordinates | Compliance Benchmark (>=90%) |

### EXECUTIVE DIAGNOSTIC SUMMARY : STATUTORY FINDINGS

An algorithmic diagnostic inspection of the public Machine-Readable File (MRF) published by Clarion Psychiatric Center revealed critical structural, syntax, and pricing irregularities that deviate from federal price transparency standards (45 CFR Section 180). The audit identified 19 compliance defects across 11 scanned chargemaster records, yielding a calculated statutory safety score of 40.8% (Grade F).

Hospitals are mandated to maintain published standard charge data that is complete, accurate, and free of placeholder records. The systemic defect patterns observed across this file leave the facility vulnerable to automated CMS crawler audits, mandatory Corrective Action Plans (CAP), and compounding daily civil monetary enforcement liabilities.

| CMS SCHEMA INTEGRITY | PAYER RATE COMPLETENESS | ENFORCEMENT LIABILITY |
|---|---|---|
| CRITICAL DEFECTS | SCHEDULES VERIFIED | ACTIVE CMP EXPOSURE |
| 45 CFR Section 180.50 | Standard Charge Completeness | 45 CFR Section 180.90 |

PUBLIC AUDIT NOTICE: This independent technical diagnostic report evaluates publicly available hospital standard charge datasets pursuant to federal Hospital Price Transparency mandates (45 CFR Part 180).

SECTION I : REGULATORY RISK ASSESSMENT

# Statutory Validation Failure & Enforcement Risk

Our automated Price Transparency Compliance Engine executed an algorithmic inspection of your facility's published Machine-Readable File (MRF). The published dataset failed statutory HPT V3.0 schema and data integrity benchmarks mandated under federal hospital price transparency rules.

### STATUTORY CIVIL MONETARY PENALTIES (45 CFR SECTION 180.90)

The Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) strictly enforces MRF compliance through automated crawlers and targeted regulatory audits. Hospitals that fail to publish complete standard charge data face daily administrative fines scaled by licensed facility bed count:

**Base Fine (<= 30 beds): $300 / day ($109,500 / year)**

**Scaled Fine (> 30 beds): $300 to $5,500 / day ($10 / bed / day) | Max: $2,007,500 / year**

SECTION II : COMPLIANCE DEFECT LEDGER

# Categorical Defect Breakdown

A granular inspection of your published dataset identified multiple categories of structural and pricing non-conformity. Missing gross charges, zero-dollar ($0.00) placeholder values, unmapped payer contracts, and schema omissions represent immediate points of regulatory exposure under federal price transparency mandates.

TOTAL DETECTED DEFECTS

**19**

Rule Violations

DEFECT FREQUENCY RATIO

**1.73**

Defect Triggers Per Inspected Row

### STATUTORY ENFORCEMENT & ADMINISTRATIVE ESCALATION TIMELINE (45 CFR SECTION 180.70 - 180.90)

CMS administrative enforcement protocols triggered upon non-compliance detection:

**1. Written Warning Notice | 30-Day Statutory Opportunity to Cure**

CMS issues formal written notice specifying non-compliant chargemaster records and missing schema attributes.

**2. Mandatory Corrective Action Plan (CAP) | Formal Remediation Protocol**

Hospital must submit a detailed CAP within 30 to 90 days outlining technical remediation steps, validation gates, and milestones.

**3. Civil Monetary Penalty (CMP) & Registry Notice | Compounding Daily Fines**

Accrual of daily fines scaled to facility capacity ($300 to $5,500/day, up to $2,007,500/year under 45 CFR Section 180.90), combined with permanent public listing on the official CMS Hospital Price Transparency Non-Compliance Registry.

SECTION III : SAMPLE VIOLATION AUDIT

# Verified Sample Violation Coordinates

Below are 5 verified sample error coordinates extracted from your published Machine-Readable File (MRF). Each entry identifies the exact source row index in your raw data file, the clinical procedure code (CPT/HCPCS), the violation taxonomy, and the statutory justification under Section 180.50.

| ROW # | CPT / CODE | VIOLATION TYPE | DESCRIPTION & STATUTORY JUSTIFICATION |
|---|---|---|---|
| **File Level**<br>Dataset Scope | **FILE_LEVEL**<br>Scope | **Schema Error** | **Invalid File Structure**<br>Missing critical columns: description. File cannot be audited. |
| **Row 3**<br>MRF Record | **0124**<br>CPT / HCPCS | **Invalid Methodology** | **Clinical Procedure**<br>Invalid methodology '% of Charges'. Must be: case rate, fee schedule, percent of total billed charges, per diem, or other. |
| **File Level**<br>Pre-Ingestion | **N/A**<br>Scope | **Compliance** | **Invalid CMS Naming Convention**<br>Filename 'temp_mrf.csv' does not follow CMS mandatory naming syntax (<EIN>_<hospital-name>_standardcharges.[csv\|json]) per 45 CFR Section 180.50(d)(5). |
| **Row 5**<br>MRF Record | **0124**<br>CPT / HCPCS | **Invalid Methodology** | **Clinical Procedure**<br>Invalid methodology '% of Charges'. Must be: case rate, fee schedule, percent of total billed charges, per diem, or other. |
| **Row 6**<br>MRF Record | **0124**<br>CPT / HCPCS | **Invalid Methodology** | **Clinical Procedure**<br>Invalid methodology '% of Medicare PPS'. Must be: case rate, fee schedule, percent of total billed charges, per diem, or other. |

## ADDITIONAL FLAGGED VIOLATIONS IN ERROR LEDGER

The 5 coordinates above represent a diagnostic cross-section of your file's defects. A total of 14 additional non-compliant records (out of 19 total detected violations) are cataloged in the complete Line-by-Line Remediation Error Ledger (Remediation_Error_Ledger.csv).
Each offline ledger record includes: exact raw row index, billing code (CPT/HCPCS/DRG/NDC), clinical description, payer contract tag, published price, and regulatory justification under Section 180.50.

| CATALOGED DEFECTS | DELIVERABLE FORMAT | DIAGNOSTIC ATTRIBUTES |
|---|---|---|
| **14 Records** | **Standard CSV (.csv)** | **6 Diagnostic Fields** |
| In Error Ledger CSV | RFC 4180 Delimited Format | Row, CPT, Payer, Price & Justification |

*Data Governance Notice: Complete row-level defect workpapers are provided directly to hospital compliance leadership and are not published in public web indices.*

SECTION IV : REMEDIATION WORKPAPERS

# Technical Remediation Workpapers & Diagnostic Data Access

To remediate the compliance defects identified in this diagnostic audit and restore full statutory alignment, Elite Data Solution maintains complete line-by-line violation workpapers available for facility revenue cycle leaders and technical teams.

## DELIVERABLE: COMPLETE LINE-BY-LINE REMEDIATION ERROR LEDGER

**Remediation_Error_Ledger.csv**

- Exhaustive line-by-line audit documenting all 19 detected violations
- Exact row coordinates mapped directly to your facility's published MRF line items
- Full clinical billing taxonomy (CPT, HCPCS, MS-DRG, NDC) & standard description fields
- Payer-specific contract discrepancy tags, zero-dollar rate flags, and statutory compliance citations
- Statutory 45 CFR Part 180 legal justification citing specific CMS price transparency mandates
- Standard RFC 4180 CSV export for hospital billing, IT, and revenue cycle analysis

| DELIVERABLE FORMAT | AUDIT COVERAGE | COMPLIANCE STANDARD |
|---|---|---|
| **CSV (.csv) / UTF-8** | **100% Scanned (11 Records)** | **45 CFR Part 180** |

## TECHNICAL WORKPAPER REQUISITION & AUDIT CUSTODY

Authorized facility compliance officers and revenue cycle leaders may request formal transmission of workpapers:

**Direct Outreach:** audit@elitedatasolution.net **Web Portal:** https://elitedatasolution.net

**Reference ID:** [MRF Remediation Workpapers] - Clarion Psychiatric Center

- **Transmission:** Delivered via email directly to authorized facility compliance leadership.
- **Defensibility:** Engineering workpapers structured pursuant to 45 CFR Part 180 statutory standards.
- **Confidentiality:** Defect workpapers are kept strictly confidential; restricted to authorized facility leadership.